

TEACHING TIPS:

- The melody in the second half of the chorus has some **semitone** intervals. Some children may find it difficult to hear these initially so take time to repeat the melody slowly so that each note is clear and sung exactly at the right pitch.
- Encourage raised eyebrows and smiles on the 'Sometimes' C# notes in the verses to make sure the children leap up to this note, as it's an easy one to sing flat if you're not careful.
- As an exercise in learning about phrasing and call-and-response singing, divide the group in two and have both groups sing one short phrase to the other throughout the verses, joining together for a rousing chorus!

WHAT YOU NEED

Amplified sound system; Internet;
tuned percussion instruments;
black/white board

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES
7 - 11

Using just two notes, sing some questions and answers.

Starting with the notes F and A, sing a question such as *What's your favourite food?* Try to arrange the notes as you sing so that you end on the higher note (A), giving the feel of a question. Then, answer (e.g. *I like hamburgers*) ending on the lower note (F).

Next, working in pairs, distribute tuned percussion instruments or keyboards and write a selection of notes on the board to use to compose simple melodies e.g. C E G or D F A. Ask the children to create melodic patterns as a musical **call and response**, one asking questions and the other answering. Suggest a theme for their musical conversation and encourage them to **write lyrics for topics** such as '*Things they talk about with Mum*' or '*Great things Mum does for me*'. Melodies should be simple and use just a few notes that repeat or echo, like the call-and-response examples in *One In A Million!* or Chuck Berry's *School Day*.

Children should **write their melodies down** using the names of the notes and some form of **notation** to help them recall their tunes for the next lesson or even sing for their mums on Mother's Day!

SPOTLIGHT ON
CALL & RESPONSE

Call-and-response songs are used a lot in singing and provide opportunities for strong singers to lead others. It is a musical technique that is popular in African music as well as Blues and Rock music. Find **Chuck Berry's School Day (Ring! Ring! Goes The Bell)** to play for the children so they can hear the example of the voice and guitar 'calling' and 'responding' to each other throughout the song.

PITCH

How high or low a note sits

Semitone – the interval between two adjacent notes on a piano or the smallest interval commonly used in classical Western music

STRUCTURE

Call and response – a musical phrase in which the first melody or rhythm is responded to or echoed by another melody or rhythm

WHAT'S
ACHIEVABLE?

To recognize use of call-and-response repeated melodies in music.

To compose call-and-response melodies and play these on instruments, using lyrics on a given theme.